

BLOGGING: LESSONS I LEARNED THE HARD WAY

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Day of Data Baton Rouge 2026



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Thank You, Sponsors!

HI, I'M JASON

THE DAX SHEPHERD*

*More semantic models, fewer sitcoms.



Honored to be
recognized by
Microsoft.

I HERD THE DATA



Microsoft MVP



Nashville, Tennessee



Fabric + Power BI



Teaching + Speaking



MY FAVORITE MODEL

TARDIS

TOOLS & ALLIES



Power BI



Microsoft Fabric



DuckDB



Python



SQL



VS Code

The Outline



- 1. Personal**
- 2. Hosting**
- 3. Topics**
- 4. Benefits**
- 5. Conclusion**

The Outline



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Did you know?

I worked with:

- SQL Server Integration Services
- BIML
- SQL Server Analysis Services Tabular

Know yourself

- I Researched Linux distributions
 - Time not spent learning Linux
- We are tech people
- Want to research and optimize
- Don't need the perfect plan
 - Guy(s) in the Cube

Syntax Highlighting

- How much DAX am I writing?
- What if most of my examples are screenshots?

PBIDAX.WORDPRESS.COM

```
Curr - Prev =  
    [Total Quantity] -  
    CALCULATE(  
        [Total Quantity],  
        OFFSET(  
            -1,  
            SUMMARIZE(ALLSELECTED('Sales'), Customer[Customer], 'Date'[  
                ORDERBY('Date'[Date])),  
            KEEP,  
            PARTITIONBY(Customer[Customer])  
        )  
    )
```

Theme (UI)

- Doesn't matter if the pages are blank
- People may read on mobile

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Hosting

- Managing infrastructure
- Time you could be Writing
- Blogging about blog platforms is not best for a Power BI career

Self-Hosting vs. Service

- Do you want to manage your own infrastructure?
- Some people who write the most content use:
 - WordPress.com
 - Hashnode (fabric.guru)
- LinkedIn
 - I prefer to promote external blog posts

Publish on Another Site

- Monetary
- Editing
- Promotion
- Examples
 - Simple Talk
 - T-SQL Tuesday
 - <https://tsqltuesday.com/>

Custom Domain

- Domain allows you to move platforms
- Buy Domain
 - Porkbun
 - Prefer set price versus promo

What did they use for that blog?

- I have looked 3 times this week alone

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Topics

- What issue did you solve
- You have a different voice
- What are you learning

Tracking Topics

- Method to track potential topics
- Word file on OneDrive with each topic
- Word file with the topic as the title
 - Put bullet points
- Notes or Reminder on Phone
- Simple Talk Link in Resources

The Outline



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Benefits: Community & Career

- Community Recognition
- Career Opportunities

Benefits: You Learn the Most

- Learn the topic
 - Same applies to:
 - Speaking
 - Tech Editing
- Improve communication skills

Rough Edges

- Human-generated content will stand out
- Don't refine away all the rough edges

Same Rules, Any Medium

- Podcasts, video, newsletters — same principles
- Pick the medium you'll actually keep doing

The Outline



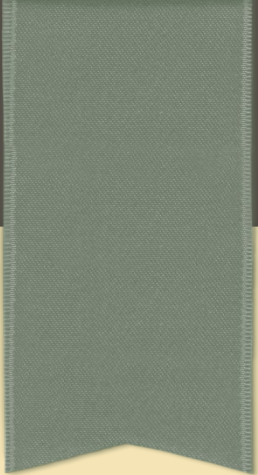
1. Personal
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Inspired by *Hamilton*

Talk less, Write More

Not about talking less at conferences — it's about talking less into the air.

Or talk endlessly — just write about it too.



WRITE!!!

or RECORD



Resources

- Simple Talk
 - <https://www.red-gate.com/simple-talk/>
- WordPress.com
 - <https://wordpress.com/>
- Idea Tracking
 - <https://www.red-gate.com/simple-talk/opinion/editorials/dont-let-that-idea-get-away/>
- Habits
 - <https://stevekamb.com/the-unfortunate-uplifting-truth-about-creating-healthy-habits>

Thank You



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Slides



Session Evaluation